Senior CSSD Specialist

Nursing · Nursing & Allied Health

Job title	Senior CSSD Specialist	**Job code**	JD-HRM-088
Department	Nursing	**Division**	Nursing & Allied Health
Grade	AH3	**Reports to**	CSSD Supervisor
Supervises	CSSD Specialists and Technicians (as assigned)	**SCFHS licence**	Yes — Category 5 — Allied Health Professional

Job Summary

Provides senior-level expertise in sterilization processes and quality assurance within CSSD. Acts as a clinical resource for CSSD staff, leads complex reprocessing activities, and ensures compliance with CBAHI IPC sterilization standards. Supports the Supervisor in staff training and competency assessment.

Essential Duties & Responsibilities

1. Performs and oversees advanced sterilization processes including steam sterilization, ethylene oxide sterilization, hydrogen peroxide plasma sterilization, and high-level disinfection. Ensures proper parameters are followed per manufacturer guidelines.
2. Acts as a clinical resource and mentor for CSSD Specialists and Technicians. Provides guidance on complex instrument reprocessing, troubleshooting sterilizer malfunctions, and interpreting biological/chemical indicator results.
3. Conducts and supervises quality assurance activities including daily Bowie-Dick tests, biological indicator testing (at least weekly), chemical indicator verification, and documentation of all sterilization records (CBAHI IPC.21.7).
4. Inspects instruments after cleaning to ensure they are in good practical condition and fit for use. Identifies damaged or worn instruments and initiates repair or replacement processes (CBAHI IPC.21.4).
5. Leads the reprocessing of complex surgical instrument sets including microsurgical instruments, endoscopes, power tools, and specialty trays. Ensures correct disassembly, cleaning, and reassembly.
6. Supports the development and delivery of CSSD training programs. Assists the Supervisor in competency assessments ensuring staff can explain sterilizer operation and parameters (CBAHI IPC.19.3).
7. Monitors unidirectional workflow compliance and environmental conditions in CSSD areas including negative pressure in decontamination and positive pressure in clean/sterile areas (CBAHI IPC.20.3).
8. Coordinates with operating rooms and procedure areas on instrument priority needs, emergency requests, and flash sterilization usage monitoring.
9. Participates in quality improvement initiatives, incident investigations related to sterilization failures, and corrective action implementation.
10. Maintains sterilization records and ensures proper lot tracking and traceability for all processed items.
11. Follows all hospital-related policies and procedures. Participates in self and others' education, training, and development. Performs other related duties as assigned.

Qualifications: Education, Training & Experience

1. Education — Bachelor's Degree or Diploma in Health Sciences, Biomedical Technology, or related discipline with CSSD certification is required.

2. Experience — 4 years of CSSD experience is required. Experience with advanced sterilization technologies and complex instrument reprocessing is preferred.
3. Licence / Certification — SCFHS registration as CSSD Technician/Specialist is required. CRCST or CBSPD certification preferred.

Skills

1. Sterile Processing: Decontamination, assembly and sterilisation technique.
2. Quality Control: Sterilizer monitoring, indicator interpretation and load release.
3. Communication: Effective liaison with OR, nursing and IPC teams.
4. Equipment Handling: Operation, QC and troubleshooting of sterilisers/washer-disinfectors.
5. Technology: Use of instrument-tracking and sterilizer-record systems.
6. Organisation: Workflow, inventory and documentation management.

Knowledge

1. Advanced sterile-processing practice, sterilizer validation and complex-device reprocessing.
2. Sterilisation monitoring/validation, Bowie-Dick testing and load-release decision-making.
3. Traceability, recall management, protocol development and staff mentoring.
4. Knowledge of CBAHI National Hospital Standards and accreditation requirements.
5. Knowledge of GDIPC Infection Prevention & Control standards and hand-hygiene practice.
6. Knowledge of applicable KSA healthcare laws, regulations and the hospital Code of Conduct.

Attitude & Behaviour

1. Respect & Integrity
2. Patient-Centred Approach
3. Accountability
4. Continuous Learning
5. Teamwork & Collaboration
6. Confidentiality
7. Professionalism
8. Adaptability & Resilience
9. Compassion & Empathy
10. Commitment to Safety

Physical Requirements

- Prolonged standing and walking during shifts.
- Ability to lift/assist patients and equipment (up to ~20 kg) with safe technique.
- Manual dexterity for clinical/technical procedures.
- Use of personal protective equipment (PPE); potential exposure to clinical hazards.
- Shift work, night shifts and on-call duties as required by the unit.

Approval

Reviewed & recommended by	Department Head	**Approved by**	HR Manager

Staff acknowledgement and signature are recorded electronically through the AMH Staff Credentials Portal.